

2/1 Bidding system

March 27, 2026

Openings:

1 2+ 12-22

1 4+ 12-22

1 5+ 12-22

1 5+ 12-22

1 balanced 15-17 includes 5M332

2 strong: 22-23 balanced or any

2 (5)6 5-10

2 (5)6 5-10

2 (5)6 5-10

2 20-21 balanced

Minor suit raise

Inverted minors

1-2 and 1-2 show an invitational or better raise without a 4 card or longer major.

Inverted minors continuations:

- New suits without jumps show stoppers, and are bid up the line.
- Jumps to new suits show shortness.

- Bidding NTs indicates that we think we have all suits stopped.

Bidding 2 or 3 of the opened minors are always not forcing. By responder it shows he only had an invitational raise, and by opener it shows he would not accept an invite.

1m - 3m show a less than invitational raise and deny a side 4 card major. The hand should be strong enough to want to be in game opposite 18-19 balanced.

Major suit raises

Simples raise

1M-2M shows at least 3 card support and 5-10 points.

Opener can bid a new suit to show values in the bid suit and interest in game opposite a maximum (8-10 points)

Mixed raise

1M-3M shows 4 card support, 6-9 points and not a flat hand (4333 or a 4432 with a two honors in the doubleton)

Maas Raise

1M-2 shows invitational or minimum (10-14 points) values 3 or more cards support.

Opener can bid 3M with a minimum to reject the invite or 4M if accepts the invite with no hope of slam.

2/1 delayed raise

When partner opens a major and we have 14/15+ points and a fit we start by bidding a new suit.

Other responses to 1 level openings

- New suits at the 1 level show 4 or more cards and are forcing 1 round.

- New suits at the 2 level without jumps show a hand two over one.
- Single jumps to a new suit show 6+ cards in the bid suit and are invitational. They deny side 4 card majors and support for partner's suit
- Double jumps to new suits are splinters.
- 1m - 1 shows 5-10 points and no suit biddable at the 1 level
- 1m - 2 is invitation balanced without 4 card majors
- 1M-1 shows 5-11 points without support for the opened majors, 1-1 also denies 4 or more spades.

1 opening

2 stayman

2 5+ transfer

2 5+ transfer

2 6+ transfer

2 6+ transfer

Stayman:

1 - 2

2 no 4 card majora

2 invitational

3 4-5 Smolen

3 4-5 Smolen

2 4 could have 4

2 Invite with 4 spades

2 Invite without 4 spades

3 4

2 4 no 4

Transfers:

1 - 2

2 2-3

2 5 invitational

3 5 - 4

3ld 5 - 4

3 5 - 5

3 6 invitational

3 5

2 4 and a maximum

3 4 and a minimum

1 - 2

2 at least Hx in

3 to play

3/M shortness

3 no honor in

pass to play

3/M shortness

2 opening

3 stayman

3 no major

- 3 4-5 Smolen

- 3 4-5 smolen

3 4 could have 4

- 3 4

3 4 no 4

3 5+

3 5+

2 Opening

2 waiting

2 Kokish: 5+ or 24+ balanced, forces 2

2 forced

- 2 24+ balanced $\rightarrow$ system on
- 3 5-4
- 3 5-4
- 3 6+
- 3 5-4

2 5+

2 Asking

- 3 5-4
- 3 5-4
- 3 5-4
- 3 6+

2 22-23 balanced $\rightarrow$ system on

3 5+

3 Asking

- 3 5 - 4
- 3 5 - 4
- 3 no 4 card majors

3 5+, no 4M

3 5 4

3 5 4

2M 5+M 8+ points

3m 6+m 8+ points

Bidding something different of the 2 waiting bid over the 2 club opener usually takes a lot of bidding space and makes it very difficult to fully describe the hand by the opener. Therefore we must be careful if we skip the relay and make it only with hands with good suits. If our suit is not good enough we should just bid the relay.

Weak 2 openings continuations

- 3 level raise: preemptive raise with 3 card support
- 4 level raise: To play, preemptive or with values
- 2 level new suit: natural forcing 1 round
- 3 level new suit: natural
- Jump to new suits(below game): splinter with slam interest
- 2: feature ask

2x - 2 feature ask

- 3x minimum
- 3 new suit: maximum with values in the bid suit
- 3: maximum with no values in the side suits
- New suit 4rth level: Shortness on the bid suit

Constructive bidding conventions

2/1 auctions

1-2 and 1-2 are natural and promising 5 or more diamonds.

1-2 similarly promises 5 or hearts and is

1-2, 1-2 and 1-2 are and could be natural or they could be from a balanced hand with no better bid.

After a 2/1 response opener describes his hand naturally, but he can not bid above 2 of the opening suit unless he has 15+ points.

Examples:

1 - 2

2 6+ or 4+ 12-14 with no other bid

2 5+ - 4 15+ (above 2 of the opening suit shows extras)

2 5+ - 4 15+

2 balanced 18-19 (could have 4 card majors)

3 5+-4+ 15+

3 solid diamond suit 15+

1 - 2

2 5+ - 4+ 12-22

2 6+ or 5 12-14 with no 4

2 waiting, usually balanced 15+

3 5+ - 4+ slam interest or worried about a heart stop

3 6+ slam interest or very unbalanced

3 5+ - 4 slam interest or worried about a club stop

3 3+ 14+, slam try

3 to play, could be from an unbalanced hand

2 18-19 balanced

3 5+-4+ 15+

3 5+-3+ 15+

3 solid spade suit 15+

Because we play Maas raise over the 1M opening delayed support trough 2/1 shows a hand with at least 15 points, therefore partner should follow the slam try unless superminimum.

XYZ

After any 1x-1y-1x auctions like:

1 - 1

1

1-1

1

...

We play:

2 forces 2

- a) A weak hand that wants to play 2 or
- b) Any invitational hand

2 ANY hands, asks partner to describe his hand

3 to play

Exemple:

1 - 1
1

2 weak or any inv

2 forced

Pass weak with 5+

2 5 - 4 inv

2 5 inv

2 4 inv

2 any

2 4 could have 3

2 3, no 4

2 no 3 and no 4

3 5+ - 4 to play

Fourth suit

When opener bids a second suit at the 2 or higher level then bidding the remaining unbid suit by the responder is game forcing and asks for more information about the opener's hand.

1 - 1
2 -?

1 - 1
2 -?

...

Bidding the fourth suit (the last remaining unbid suit) is artificial and game forcing. It asks if opener has 3 card support for responder's suit or a stopper in the fourth suit.

With no 3 card support nor a stopper in the fourth suit and no other descriptive bid to make opener can rebid his opening suit: waiting and showing no better bid.

Third suit game forcing

After a 1 level opening and a ONE of a SUIT response and opener rebidding his opening suit at the 2 level:

1 - 1

2

1 - 1

2

...

Bidding without jumping one of the two remaining suits is game forcing. The bids are natural in principle, but could be done on just a 2 or 3 card suit if worried about a stopper in the remaining unbid suit. The cheaper of the two bids could also be done without a real suit in order to set up a game forcing auction.

Exemple:

1 - 1

2 - ?

2 3 suit , it doesn't promise diamonds

2 5+ - 4, no 3

2 3

2 stopper, no 3

3 6+, no 3, no good stop

3 5+ - 4

2 3 suit , usually 4+, could be just 3 looking for a stop

2 3

- 2** stopper
- 3** 6+ no stopper, no 3

Checkback

After 1m-1M-2 :: 3 is checkback and asks for 3 card support in the major or 4 cards in the other major:

1m - 1M

2 - ?

3 checkback

3 3M AND 4oM

3M 3M no 4oM

3oM 4oM no 3M

3 no 3M nor 4oM

3M 6+M game forcing

Slam bidding

- 1430 RKCB
- Non serious 3
- Italian style cuebids

Competitive bidding

We open and they overcall

If they double our 1 of a suit opening bid:

ReDBL	11+ any distribution
1 of a suit	natural F1
1	natural 8-10
2 of a suit	natural (7-10)
Jump support	preemptive.
Jump into new suit	preemptive.

If they overcall with 1

DBL	9+ points
2 of a suit	natural to play

If they overcall with a new suit

DBL	8+ points, TO and no other bid
1 of a suit	8+ 4+suit F1
1	8-10 with a stopper. No support or unbid 4 card major
2 of a suit(no jump)	11+ 5+suit, forcing up to suit rebid
2 of opening suit	simple raise 5-10
3 of a suit(no jump)	5+suit
Cuebid	support 11+
Jump cuebid	support with shortness in opponents suit
Jump support	preemptive

Two suited overcalls

Unusual two no trumps:

(1x) - 2 shows at least 5/5 in the lowest ranking unbid suits.

Micheal cuebid:

(1m) - 2m shows at least a 5/5 in the majors

(1M) - 2M shows at least 5 cards in the unbid major and 5 cards in one of the two minors. Partner can use 2(or 4) to ask which is the minor

After we overcall at the 1 or 2 level without jump

- New suits at the 1 level are forcing for 1 round
- New suits at the 2 level are not forcing but show a constructive or invitational hand
- New suits at the 3 level are both with and without a jump
- 1/2 are both natural showing a stopper in the opponents' suit. 1 shows 8-11 points, 2 after a 1 level overcall shows 12-14 points and 2 after a 2 level overcall show 9-11 points.
- Cuebidding opponents' suit without jump shows either an invitational or better support or a balanced hand with enough strength to play game but no stopper in opponents suit.

- Jump cuebidding shows a mixed raise (4card support 6-9hcp and some distribution)

(1) - 1 - (pass) - ?

1 4+ F1

1 8-11 with a stopper

2 invitational or better support or 15+ points balanced with no stopper

2 5+ 9-14 MF

2 3+ 7-10

2 12-14 with a stopper

3 mixed raise

3 5+

UBH

The name is self explanatory